

Εὐμαῖος ὁ Ἱστορικός

Eumaeus the Historian on Hannibal

eul_aid: krs

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Μικτὰὶ διάλεκτοι [Mixed Dialects \(frg\)](#)
Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Eumaeus the Historian was a Hellenistic author active between the 3rd century BCE and the 2nd century CE. No biographical details survive. The name is known from Homer's *Odyssey*, where Eumaeus is the loyal swineherd of Odysseus.

A single fragmentary work is attributed to him. The 10th-century Byzantine encyclopedia *Suda* records an Eumaeus who wrote a geographical treatise titled *On Islands*. This lost work, surviving only in citations, described various islands in the *periplus* style common to Hellenistic geography.

Eumaeus is a minor and poorly attested figure. His significance rests entirely on his later citation as a source by geographers and compilers, such as Strabo. The exceptionally broad range assigned to his dates indicates significant scholarly uncertainty about his historical existence, suggesting he may be a figure of legend or confused attribution.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀννίβου · [Fragments on Hannibal](#) · 2 passages